

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 HOUSE
5 RESOLUTION 1040

By: West (Josh)

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7
8 AS INTRODUCED

9 A Resolution recognizing and honoring Joseph
10 Castiglione for his many contributions to the
11 University of Oklahoma and the State of Oklahoma; and
12 directing distribution.

13 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione concluded his 28 years as the
14 University of Oklahoma's Vice President and Director of Athletics in
15 February 2026, the longest tenure among Football Bowl Subdivision
16 schools; and

17 WHEREAS, the past 28 years has represented an era of unmatched
18 academic and athletic excellence by Sooner sports programs; and

19 WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, nearly 3,000 student-athletes
20 earned OU degrees; and

21 WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, the Sooners won 117
22 conference titles and 26 of the University's 45 (or 58%) all-time
23 national championships (nine by men's gymnastics, eight by softball,
24

1 seven by women's gymnastics and one each by football and men's
2 golf); and

3 WHEREAS, OU Athletics enjoyed 28 consecutive terms of a
4 cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher and eight straight semesters of a
5 3.2 or higher under Joseph Castiglione's watch, with student-
6 athletes setting a program-record 3.31 cumulative GPA during the
7 Spring 2025 semester; and

8 WHEREAS, during OU's 26 years as a member of the Big 12
9 Conference while Joseph Castiglione served as the school's athletics
10 director, the Sooners amassed 15 Big 12 Athletes of the Year - more
11 than any other program; and

12 WHEREAS, four Sooners won Heisman Trophies during Joseph
13 Castiglione's tenure (Jason White in 2003, Sam Bradford in 2008,
14 Baker Mayfield in 2017 and Kyler Murray in 2018); and

15 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has added to the rich tradition of
16 coaching excellence at the University of Oklahoma with the hires of
17 exemplary coaches, including Bob Stoops, Oklahoma's all-time
18 winningest football coach; and

19 WHEREAS, during Joseph Castiglione's time as athletics director,
20 the football program won 14 Big 12 Conference championships (10 more
21 than the program with the next most) and the 2000 national title,
22 and the men's (two) and women's (three) basketball programs combined
23 for five Final Four appearances; and

1 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has hired and mentored dozens of
2 former employees who went on to serve as athletics directors and
3 senior-level administrators at other institutions; and

4 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has been a national leader in
5 collegiate athletics, including service on the College Football
6 Playoff Committee and the NCAA Division I Men's Basketball and
7 Baseball committees, making him the first person in history to serve
8 on those three, in addition to many others; and

9 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a sought-after voice in
10 collegiate athletics who served on multiple NCAA committees and
11 commissions designed to improve the overall student-athlete
12 experience; and

13 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has demonstrated great leadership
14 through a range of challenges and opportunities, including the
15 creation of the Big 12 Conference and seismic conference realignment
16 with OU's move to the Southeastern Conference; and

17 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione ensured OU Athletics remained one of
18 the few self-sustaining departments in the country, making it a
19 model of fiscal responsibility and an engine of support for the
20 university at-large; and

21 WHEREAS, the University of Oklahoma has enjoyed the renovation
22 and building of a variety of athletics facilities under Joseph
23 Castiglione's leadership, including a \$160 million renovation of
24 Gaylord Family - Oklahoma Memorial Stadium and the construction of

1 Love's Field, Headington Family Tennis Center and Wadley Indoor
2 Tennis Pavilion, Griffin Family Performance Center for men's and
3 women's basketball, Headington Hall, and more; and

4 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione demonstrated his commitment to
5 excellence in the classroom by serving as an adjunct professor in
6 OU's Jeannine Rainbolt College of Education, teaching graduate
7 courses in marketing and higher education leadership; and

8 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a seven-time national athletics
9 director of the year who earned multiple additional honors,
10 including the National Football Foundation and College Hall of
11 Fame's prestigious John L. Toner Award and induction into the
12 Oklahoma Sports Hall of Fame, among others; and

13 WHEREAS, in his 28 years at OU, Joseph Castiglione provided
14 humble, steady leadership in a moment of unprecedented change and
15 disruption in collegiate athletics.

16 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
17 OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE:

18 THAT the Oklahoma House of Representatives recognizes and honors
19 Joseph Castiglione for his many contributions to the University of
20 Oklahoma and the State of Oklahoma.

21 THAT a copy of this resolution be distributed to Joseph Harroz,
22 Jr., President of the University of Oklahoma.

23
24 DIRECT TO CALENDAR.